

# Can AI keep up with the growing energy demands?

Posted by u/sasserdev • 0 points • 11 comments

I just finished an article exploring AI's skyrocketing energy demands, the challenges of scaling renewables, and solutions like quantum computing and efficient hardware.

What do you think—can innovation keep up, or are we heading for trouble? Let me know your thoughts!

## Comments

u/TheRobotCluster • 3 points • 2024-12-21 14:57 UTC

If we mindlessly destroy Earth to create more energy, obviously that would be a bad thing. But how much total footprint would an average human working on the solution leave? A Fusion researcher might leave a huge total carbon footprint on the world by the time they make a 10% improvement on Fusion. I'd guess that AI could result in a net reduction in carbon footprint for that same 10% of progress

u/Toms\_story • 2 points • 2024-12-21 11:24 UTC

For the ai centers, they will probably start relying on small modular nuclear reactors plugging directly to the data centers. But this will take a few years to scale up. I think we will be able to keep up with the energy demand for these ai systems in a few years without too much externalities

u/Signal\_Example\_4477 • 2 points • 2024-12-21 20:52 UTC

Honestly it'd be 20 years away at least. Just the policy changes to allow for small nuclear reactors all over will take years.

u/ConsiderationFew3371 • 2 points • 2024-12-21 13:55 UTC

The US hasn't even built a single SMR for public utility use. I think it would be a decade or more before a private company is able to get one for a datacenter

u/sasserdev • 1 points • 2024-12-21 11:32 UTC

I really appreciate your optimistic perspective. With corporations collaborating and the global community uniting to address this challenge, achieving this goal is absolutely possible.

u/NoWeather1702 • 4 points • 2024-12-21 10:19 UTC

We are not even producing enough food for everybody and the global economy is holding on using cheap labour in different countries. But let's focus on building AI and plants to power it up alongside crypto miners!

**u/BoJackHorseMan53** • 2 points • 2024-12-21 12:24 UTC

Producing more food isn't as profitable

**u/Toms\_story** • 9 points • 2024-12-21 11:23 UTC

We are producing more than enough food to feed everyone. The developed nations are just over consuming and wasting so much food. Not a production issue, it's an equity issue. But still a problem for sure

**u/sasserdev** • 1 points • 2024-12-21 11:35 UTC

You make a great point—it's not really about how much food we're producing but how it's being distributed and consumed. Developed nations waste an incredible amount of food, which contributes to this inequity. Fixing this isn't just about producing more; it's about addressing systemic issues like food distribution, overconsumption, and waste. It's definitely a problem we need to tackle together.

**u/AnotherSoftEng** • 1 points • 2024-12-21 11:41 UTC

It's difficult to engage with ChatGPT responses just fyi. Use it to understand the context of the situation better, but write your own stuff. Know that people go on Reddit to engage with people. The minute someone reads token outputs, it feels like engaging with a robot

**u/sasserdev** • -1 points • 2024-12-21 11:45 UTC

I understand where you're coming from, and I think many people feel the same way about AI-generated responses. However, I've been working on a streamlined workflow that combines AI assistance with human creativity and authenticity. It's designed to ensure that what I write feels natural and personal, while also benefiting from the research and organizational power of tools like ChatGPT and its new Projects Feature.

I'll be writing an article next week about this workflow to share how it bridges the gap between AI and genuine human interaction. I'll make a note to let you know when it's published—I'd love to hear your thoughts on it.

**u/Quirky\_Bag\_4250** • 4 points • 2024-12-21 11:03 UTC

Couldn't agree with you more, especially about the food.